

XAUUSD DOMINATION

Institutional Sniper Strategy Blueprint

By Oscar

Smart Money Concepts · Liquidity Engineering · Sniper Execution

A complete institutional-grade trading framework for mastering Gold (XAU/USD). Built for serious traders who refuse to be the liquidity.

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CHAPTER 1 — INTRODUCTION

Why Gold, Why You're Losing

Gold (XAU/USD) is the single most manipulated financial instrument accessible to retail traders. It combines the mechanics of a currency pair with the volatility of a commodity, layered on top of institutional order flow that dwarfs any single retail participant. Before you can profit consistently, you must understand the battlefield you are entering.

The Nature of XAUUSD

Gold trades approximately \$130–180 billion in notional volume daily. Central banks, sovereign wealth funds, hedge funds, and market-making institutions dominate this market. The pip value on a standard lot is \$10 per \$0.10 move, meaning a 200-pip intraday swing — entirely normal for Gold — is a \$2,000 swing per lot. This is not a market for guesswork.

- XAUUSD is priced in US Dollars per troy ounce.
- It moves 50–200 pips per session on average.
- It correlates inversely with the USD Index (DXY) most of the time.
- Sessions: London (08:00–12:00 GMT), New York (13:00–17:00 GMT) drive 80% of movement.
- Sunday gaps are common and often filled.

Why Gold Is Manipulated

Manipulation in trading does not mean illegal conspiracy. It means that institutions with massive liquidity requirements must engineer price to reach areas where they can fill their orders without slippage. To buy 50,000 lots, you need sellers. Those sellers are retail traders whose stop losses sit above obvious highs. Institutions drive price into those stops, collect the liquidity, and then reverse. This is the core engine of Smart Money Concepts.

levels — a 'stop hunt' or 'liquidity raid'.

3. Once retail is stopped out, institutions have their fill — they

Why Most Traders Fail

- They trade lagging indicators (RSI, MACD, Moving Averages) on their own without structure context.
- They place stop losses at logical technical levels — which institutions specifically target.
- They enter at obvious support/resistance, not at institutional order flow zones.
- They fight the higher timeframe bias with lower timeframe counter-trend entries.
- They risk too much per trade, allowing one loss to cascade into account destruction.
- They overtrade during low-liquidity windows (Asian session, news spikes).
- They have no systematic checklist — they trade based on feeling.

This book gives you the framework to be on the RIGHT side of every one of those failure points. By the end, you will think and act like an institutional trader — because you will be using their logic.

CHAPTER 2 — BASIC MARKET STRUCTURE

Market structure is the language of price. Before any entry, any zone, any model — you must read structure fluently. All SMC logic sits on top of structure.

The Four Phases

- **Bullish Structure:** Series of Higher Highs (HH) and Higher Lows (HL) — price is in an uptrend.
- **Bearish Structure:** Series of Lower Highs (LH) and Lower Lows (LL) — price is in a downtrend.
- **Range/Consolidation:** Equal highs and equal lows — institutions accumulating or distributing.
- **Transitional Structure:** Break of structure signals potential trend change.

■■■ CHART EXAMPLE ■■■

[BULLISH MARKET STRUCTURE — 4H XAUUSD]

Price (USD)

2380 | * HH3

| * HH2 /

2360 | * HH1 / \ /

| * HL1 / \ * HL2 / \ * HL3 /

2340 | / \ / \ / \ /

| / \ / \ / \ /

2320 | ___/ ___/ ___/

+----->

Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Time

■ HH = Higher High | HL = Higher Low | Each HL holds — BULLISH CONFIRMED

■ Structure break above previous HH = continuation signal

■ Entry zone: pullback to HL area (demand zone) after each HH

■ Stop: below the most recent HL

■ Target: next projected HH extension

■■■ END CHART ■■■

■■■ CHART EXAMPLE ■■■

[BEARISH MARKET STRUCTURE — 1H XAUUSD]

Price (USD)

2360 | ____ LH1

| \ / LH2

2340 | * / \ LH3

| * \ / \

2320 | \ LL1 * LL2

| \ \

2300 | * LL1 \ * LL3

| \ /

2280 | * LL2

+----->

Time -->

- LH = Lower High | LL = Lower Low | Structure is bearish throughout
- Each rally fails to break previous LH = bearish pressure intact
- Entry zone: rally into LH area (supply zone) — short entry
- Stop: above the most recent LH
- Target: next LL projection

■■■ END CHART ■■■

Internal vs External Structure

External structure = the major swing highs and lows visible on the 4H or 1H chart. These define the overall trend. Internal structure = smaller swings within a leg of external structure, visible on M15 or M5. Internal breaks give you entry triggers aligned with external bias.

ks against EXTERNAL structure direction.

Example: If 4H is bearish, only take bearish internal BOS on M

CHAPTER 3 — MULTI-TIMEFRAME STRUCTURE

The Top-Down Analysis Framework

Professional traders don't look at one timeframe. They work top-down — starting with the highest timeframe to determine directional bias, then drilling down to execution timeframes. This prevents the most common retail mistake: taking a great-looking M15 trade against a D1 trend.

/Discount zones. Major OBs.

1H — Refined bias. Entry context zones. CHoCH identification

Alignment Rules

1. Determine D1 bias: Is price making HH/HL (bullish) or LH/LL (bearish)?
2. Mark D1 key liquidity pools — previous day highs/lows, equal highs/lows.
3. Drop to 4H: Confirm alignment. Is 4H structure agreeing with D1?
4. On 4H, identify the relevant order block or supply/demand zone price is approaching.
5. Drop to 1H: Look for CHoCH or BOS in the direction of HTF bias inside that zone.
6. Drop to M15: Find the FVG or OB that serves as your entry point.
7. M5/M1: Confirm the candle pattern, entry trigger, and set precise SL/TP.

[TOP-DOWN ANALYSIS — D1 → 4H → M15 ALIGNMENT]

[illegible]

HL at 2300 held. Bias = BUY

[illegible]

4H: 2380\

[illegible]

M15: 2335\ /2338

[FVG: 2330.2 – 2330.8] ← ENTRY HERE

TP1: 2342 | TP2: 2358 | TP3: 2375 (partial at each)

■ Any M15 bearish setup here is IGNORED — it fights D1 and 4H bias.

■■■ END CHART ■■■

CHAPTER 4 — MECHANICAL STRUCTURE RULES

Break of Structure (BOS)

A Break of Structure occurs when price closes BEYOND a significant swing point in the direction of the prevailing trend. A BOS confirms continuation — the trend is alive.

■■■ CHART EXAMPLE ■■■

[BOS — BULLISH CONTINUATION (1H)]

```
2360 | * BOS confirmed here
      | / (close above prev HH)
2350 | * HH1 /
      | / \ * HL1 /
2340 | / \ / \ /
      | / \ /
2330 | _____/ \_ / ← HL2 holds (demand respected)
+----->
|BOS| ← candle closes above HH1 = BOS confirmed
```

- BOS is ONLY valid on a candle CLOSE above/below the structural level.
- A wick through the level is NOT a BOS — it is a liquidity sweep.
- After BOS in direction of trend: look for retracement into FVG/OB for entry.

■■■ END CHART ■■■

Change of Character (CHoCH)

A Change of Character is the FIRST break of structure AGAINST the prevailing trend. It signals a potential trend reversal. Unlike BOS, CHoCH should be treated with caution — it requires higher timeframe confirmation before committing to full position.

■■■ CHART EXAMPLE ■■■

[CHoCH — TREND REVERSAL SIGNAL (M15)]

Bearish context (LH/LL sequence ongoing):

```

2350 | LH1 *
| \
2340 | \ * LH2
| \ / \
2330 | * \ ← LL2
| LL1 \ \
2320 | \ * ← price rallies HERE
| \ /
2315 | \ / ← CHoCH: close ABOVE LH2
| (first time in downtrend structure)
+----->
  
```

- CHoCH = bullish close above most recent LH in a downtrend.
- This is the FIRST signal of a potential reversal — not a confirmed buy yet.
- Wait for 4H/1H confirmation: is HTF also showing a structural shift?
- If HTF confirms, look for OB/FVG on M15 to enter long.

■■■ END CHART ■■■

Valid vs Invalid Breaks

■ VALID BREAK

- Candle BODY closes beyond the level.
- Multiple candles close beyond the level.
- Break occurs with above-average momentum.
- Break aligns with HTF bias direction.
- Break immediately followed by continuation.

■ INVALID BREAK

- Only the WICK pierces the level (stop hunt, not BOS).
- Candle closes at the level but doesn't clear it.
- Break occurs on micro-timeframe only (M1 noise).
- Break opposes D1/4H direction.
- Break immediately reverses — likely a trap.

CHAPTER 5 — SUPPLY & DEMAND MECHANICS

Supply and demand zones are the footprints of institutional orders. They are not arbitrary support/resistance lines — they are areas where large orders were placed, partially filled, and left behind. Price must return to fill those orders.

The Institutional Perspective

Imagine a bank needs to buy 10,000 lots of Gold. The retail market can't absorb that instantly. The bank places a limit order at 2310 and fills 3,000 lots. Price moves away. Later, price returns to 2310 — the bank fills the remaining 7,000 lots. That 2310 area is a DEMAND ZONE.

■■■ CHART EXAMPLE ■■■

[DEMAND ZONE FORMATION & REACTION (1H)]

```
2380 | * TP Target
      | _____/
2360 | /
      | /
2340 | _____/ ← BOS (confirm demand valid)
      | /
2320 | ----/--[DEMAND ZONE: 2305-2315]-----
      | Origin candle: Strong bull candle from 2305→2335
2310 | [OB: last bearish candle before rally] ← Refined entry
      | ↑ Price returns here later – ENTRY ZONE
2300 | \
      +---\----->
      ← Price sweeps to 2303 (BSL raid) then rockets up
```

- Zone is identified by the **BASE** of an impulsive move (origin candle).
- The demand zone spans from the **LOW** of the origin candle to its open.
- Refined entry: inside the zone at the last bearish OB (order block).
- SL: 5–8 pips below the zone's lowest wick.
- Demand zone is **VALID** until price breaks below it (then it flips to supply).

■■■ END CHART ■■■

Strong vs Weak Zones

■ STRONG ZONE

Fresh — price has NEVER returned here.

■ WEAK ZONE

Price has already reacted from it once or more.

Created by a strong, impulsive move away.

Caused a BOS on the departure.

Aligns with HTF structure bias.

Has a clear origin candle.

Created by a slow, grinding move.

Did NOT cause a BOS on departure.

Against HTF bias direction.

Zone boundary is ambiguous/unclear.

CHAPTER 6 — SELECTING HIGH-PROBABILITY ZONES

Not every zone is worth trading. Elite traders are ruthlessly selective. Here is the framework Oscar should use to qualify every zone before committing capital.

Zone Qualification Checklist

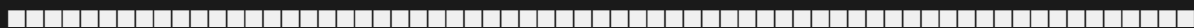
1. HTF Alignment: Does the zone align with D1 and 4H structure direction?
2. Zone Freshness: Has price visited this zone before? Fresh = higher probability.
3. Origin Candle Quality: Was the departure candle impulsive and strong?
4. Premium/Discount: Is a demand zone in a discount (below 50% of the range)? Is a supply zone in premium?
5. Liquidity Below/Above: Is there a pool of stops that price needs to clear before entering the zone?
6. Confluence: Is there an OB, FVG, or session high/low aligning with the zone?
7. Risk/Reward: Can you get at minimum 1:3 R:R from this zone entry?

CHART EXAMPLE

[ZONE REFINEMENT — FROM WIDE TO PRECISE (M15 Zoom)]

WIDE ZONE (initial identification on 1H):

[SUPPLY ZONE: 2370 - 2380] – identified by impulsive bearish leg



REFINED ENTRY (drill to M15):

```
2380 | ■■■■ ← Top of zone (wick high)
```

2378 |  ← Last bullish OB candle (M15) = REFINED ENTRY

2376 | ■■■■

2374 | ← FVG sits here (2373.8 - 2374.5)

2372 | ■■■■ ← Bottom of supply zone base

1

Entry: SHORT at 2377.5 (top of M15 OB within 1H supply zone)

SL: 2381.5 (above zone wick high + 3 pip buffer)

TP1: 2360 | TP2: 2345 | TP3: 2330 (D1 demand below)

- Wide zone from 1H gives context. M15 OB inside that zone gives precision.
- Entering at the refined level reduces SL size = better R:R.
- The FVG inside the zone is the magnets price will tap on return.
- Never enter at the TOP of a wide zone — refine always.

END CHART

CHAPTER 7 — INTRODUCTION TO LIQUIDITY

Liquidity is the engine of all price movement. Understanding it separates consistently profitable traders from the masses who perpetually get stopped out.

What Liquidity Is

In trading, liquidity refers to pending orders — specifically stop losses. Every retail trader who buys places a stop BELOW a recent low. Every retail trader who sells places a stop ABOVE a recent high. These clusters of stop orders represent 'resting liquidity' — orders that institutions can use to fill their large positions.

s of long buyers sitting BELOW swing lows.

Institutions BUY into BSL (they hit stops above highs to fill sell

Types of Liquidity Pools

- **Equal Highs (EQH):** Two or more swing highs at the same level — high-density BSL sitting above.
- **Equal Lows (EQL):** Two or more swing lows at the same level — high-density SSL sitting below.
- **Previous Day High/Low:** Always marked — widely watched by retail, hence targeted.
- **Previous Week High/Low:** Major liquidity — institutional-level targets.
- **Round Numbers:** 2300, 2350, 2400 — psychological levels, mass stop clusters.
- **Trendline Liquidity:** Stops placed under rising trendlines by retail long traders.

CHAPTER 8 — HIGHS & LOWS LIQUIDITY

Equal Highs, Equal Lows, Stop Hunts & Inducement

■■■ CHART EXAMPLE ■■■

[EQUAL HIGHS STOP HUNT → REVERSAL (1H XAUUSD)]

2355 | ~~BSL above EQH~~
2352 | * EQH1 ■■■■■■■■■■ * EQH2 ← retail shorts place SL here
| | |
2345 | | (consolidation range) |
| | |
2338 | | _____ | ← SSL below EQL
2336 |
2352 | * ← SWEEP of EQH
| (wicks above 2352 – BSL hunted, shorts stopped out)
| \
2340 | \
2332 | | _____
| ← Price dumps AFTER sweeping BSL
ENTRY: SHORT on M15 CHoCH after sweep of EQH
SL: above the sweep wick (3 pips above EQH sweep high)
TP: SSL below range (2336 area)

- Price holds EQH twice → retail sees double top → places stops ABOVE.
- Institution sweeps those stops (collects BSL) then reverses sharply.
- The sweep candle wicks above EQH but CLOSES back inside the range.
- That close-back-inside is the entry confirmation signal.

■■■ END CHART ■■■

Inducement (IDM)

Inducement is a smaller liquidity pool that price sweeps to lure retail traders in, BEFORE taking out the REAL target. Institutions create a small rally, retail buys the breakout, then price sweeps those new longs before making the real move.

■■■ CHART EXAMPLE ■■■

[INDUCEMENT BEFORE REAL MOVE (M15)]

Bullish setup in D1 context. Price in a 1H demand zone.

|

2332 | * IDM High ← small high created

| / \ Retail longs form here,

2328 | / \ SL placed below the IDM low

| / _ ← IDM Low SWEPT (SSL below IDM)

2324 | / | \ Retail stops hit, institutions buy

| / | \

2320 |____/ [DEMAND ZONE: 2318-2322]

| _____ /→ Real move up begins

Entry: BUY after IDM SSL sweep + M15 CHoCH bullish

SL: Below IDM sweep wick (2316.5)

TP: Above IDM high + HTF targets

■ IDM is the 'fake out' before the real move — always watch for it inside zones.

■ The IDM sweep looks scary to retail (they see new lows) but is actually the entry.

■ Only valid when price is inside an HTF demand zone.

■■■ END CHART ■■■

CHAPTER 9 — THE SNIPER STRATEGY CORE

The Sniper Strategy is a three-step framework that combines liquidity, structure, and precision entry into one repeatable process. It is the backbone of every trade in this book.

provides a liquidity pool (stop hunt above/below key level).

Step 2: STRUCTURE SHIFT — Price creates a CHoCH on the

CHART EXAMPLE

[SNIPER ENTRY — FULL SEQUENCE (M15 XAUUSD)]

Context: 4H bearish. 1H supply zone: 2368-2374. Price rallying into it.

Step 1 – LIQUIDITY SWEEP:

```
2374 | * SWEEP ← price wicks above 2372 (BSL raided)
```

2372 | * LH

```
| / \ ← Closes BACK inside supply zone
```

2368 | / \

| [1H SUPPLY ZONE: 2368-2374]

Step 2 – STRUCTURE SHIFT (CHoCH on M15):

```
2370 | * LH ← fails to break sweep high
```

2366 | / \ ← LL formed → M15 CHoCH bearish

2364 | / \ _____

/

Step 3 – ENTRY at FVG:

2369 | [FVG: 2369.2-2369.8] ← price retraces into FVG after CHOCH

SHORT ENTRY: 2369.5

SL: 2374.8 (above sweep wick)

TP1: 2358 | TP2: 2344 | TP3: 2330 (SSL below)

R:R = 1:4.5 on TP2

- This is the complete Sniper sequence: Sweep → Shift → Entry.
- Without ALL THREE steps, there is NO trade.
- The FVG acts as the magnet that pulls price back for your entry.
- SL always above the sweep — never inside the zone.

■■■ END CHART ■■■

CHAPTER 10 — SNIPER ENTRY MODELS

MODEL 1: Liquidity Sweep Reversal

This is the purest expression of institutional order flow. Price sweeps a key liquidity level, then reverses aggressively. Entry is taken at the first FVG or OB formed after the structural shift.

p).

■ Price sweeps the liquidity level (wick through, then CLOSE BACK inside).

■ M1

■■■ CHART EXAMPLE ■■■

[MODEL 1 — SELL-SIDE LIQUIDITY SWEEP REVERSAL (LONG SETUP, 1H)]

4H context: BULLISH. 1H demand zone: 2318–2325.

Price has been making HH/HL. A HL forms at 2318.

2322 | _____

| /

2318 | _____/ ← HL (Higher Low) – retail longs SL here

2315 | ←■■ SWEEP: price dips to 2314.8 (SSL grabbed)

2313 | ↓ wick low touches 2314.8

| ↑ candle CLOSES BACK above 2318 (HL held)

M15 CHoCH: bullish close above internal LH → shift confirmed

FVG: 2319.2 – 2320.1 (gap left by CHoCH candle body)

ENTRY: BUY LIMIT @ 2319.5 (inside FVG)

SL: 2313.5 (below sweep wick, 1.3 pip buffer)

TP1: 2332 (internal high) R:R = 1:2.0

TP2: 2345 (HTF BOS level) R:R = 1:4.2

TP3: 2358 (previous HTF HH) R:R = 1:6.5

■ The SSL sweep is the SIGNAL — not a random dip.

■ Close back inside HL confirms the sweep is complete.

■ FVG is your precision entry — not the broad demand zone.

■ Scale out: 50% at TP1, 30% at TP2, 20% at TP3.

■■■ END CHART ■■■

MODEL 2: London Manipulation Setup

London opens at 08:00 GMT and is famous for engineered moves designed to trap both Asian session breakout traders and early London directional traders. The manipulation move occurs in the first 60–90 minutes, followed by the TRUE London directional move.

■ Sweep of Asian range high/low = manipulation candle.

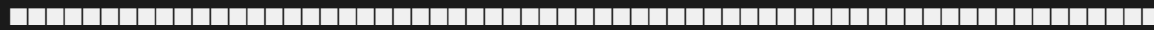
■ After

CHART EXAMPLE

[MODEL 2 — LONDON MANIPULATION (SWEEP ASH → SELL)]

Asian Session range: ASL = 2340.0 | ASH = 2346.5

Range size = 6.5 pips



08:00 GMT London open:

```
2348 | * ← 08:15: sweep of ASH to 2347.8 (BSL grabbed)
```

[illegible]

2344 | \

```
2342 | \ ← price dumps aggressively after BSL sweep
```

[illegible]

2338 | \

```
2335 | \_____→ London TRUE MOVE direction = DOWN
```

M15 CHoCH bearish @ 2343.2 confirmed at 08:45 GMT

FVG: 2344.5 – 2345.2 (entry zone – short here)

SHORT ENTRY: 2344.8 SL: 2348.5 TP: 2331 (=2x Asian range down)

$$R:R = 1:3.7$$

- The ASH/ASL defines London's manipulation target.
- NEVER trade the initial London direction — wait for the sweep and reversal.
- Best traded from 08:00–10:00 GMT. Avoid after 11:30 GMT.
- If BOTH ASH and ASL are swept before a directional move — wait for NY.

END CHART

MODEL 3: New York Continuation

New York session (13:00–17:00 GMT) typically CONFIRMS and CONTINUES the London directional move, after a brief consolidation or minor pullback at the NY open (13:00–13:30 GMT).

- M15 shows no CHoCH against London direction — only minor retracement.

- Ent

[MODEL 3 — NY CONTINUATION LONG (M15)]

■■■■ END CHART ■■■■

CHART EXAMPLE

[MODEL 4 — TREND PULLBACK ENTRY — SELL (4H → M15)]

D1 trend: BEARISH. 4H: LH/LL sequence. BOS below 2360.

Last 4H impulse: 2380 → 2355 (25-pip drop)

4H OB (last bull candle before drop): 2377-2380

[illegible]

4H chart:

2382 | LH *

```
2378 | \ ← [4H 0B: 2377-2380] (last bull candle)
```

2374 | \

2365 | _

```
2358 | \ BOS below 2360
```

2352 | \underline{\hspace{1.5cm}}

1

M15 pullback sequence (3 days later):

```
2368 | * pullback LH
```

2371 | / \

2375 | / __ ← price reaches 4H 0B zone

```
2378 | / [OB: 2377-2380] ← M15 CHoCH bearish here
```

```
| bearish → entry short
```

SHORT: 2378.5 SL: 2381.5 TP1: 2358 TP2: 2340 TP3: 2320

R:R = 1:6.5 to TP1

- This model rewards patience — you wait for price to come to you.
- The OB is your zone. The M15 CHoCH is your trigger.
- Risk is minimal because SL is above the OB — a tight, logical placement.
- Works best in strong D1 trends. Avoid in ranging markets.

■■■ END CHART ■■■

CHAPTER 11 — FAIR VALUE GAPS (FVG)

A Fair Value Gap is a three-candle imbalance where price moves so fast that the high of the first candle and the low of the third candle do NOT overlap. This gap represents unfilled orders — institutions need to return to this area to rebalance their book.

Identifying FVGs

1. Take any three consecutive candles on your chart.
2. Check: does the HIGH of candle 1 leave a GAP below the LOW of candle 3? (for bullish FVG)
3. The gap between C1 high and C3 low = the FVG zone.
4. Mark the FVG zone with a box on your chart.
5. Wait for price to return and react from the FVG.

CHART EXAMPLE

[FVG FORMATION & MITIGATION (M15 XAUUSD)]

Bullish FVG formation example:

Candle 1: Open 2340 High 2343 Low 2339 Close 2342

Candle 2: Open 2343 High 2351 Low 2342 Close 2350 ← impulse

Candle 3: Open 2350 High 2352 Low 2345 Close 2351

FVG = between C1 High (2343) and C3 Low (2345)

FVG zone = [2343 - 2345]

[illegible]

Chart view:

```
2355 | * (new high - target)
```

2351 | ■■■■■■

2350 | ■■■■■■

2345 | ■■■■[FVG TOP]■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■

2343 | ■ ■ ■ ■ [FVG BOT] ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■

2342 | ■■■■■■

2340 | ■■■■■■

```
| ↑ price returns to FVG zone → BUY LIMIT
```

ENTRY: BUY @ 2344 (midpoint of FVG) SL: 2340 TP: 2358

- The 50% midline of the FVG (2344 in this case) is the optimal entry.
- FVGs on M5/M15 within a higher TF OB = HIGHEST probability entry.
- If price CLOSES through an FVG without reacting, the FVG is invalidated.
- Mark ALL FVGs on your execution timeframe. They act as magnets.

■■■ END CHART ■■■

How Institutions Use FVGs

Institutions create FVGs intentionally when they need to partially fill a large order quickly. The gap signals that not all orders were filled. When price retraces into the FVG, the remaining institutional orders get filled — and the original impulse direction resumes.

CHAPTER 12 — ORDER BLOCKS

An Order Block (OB) is the last opposing candle before a strong impulsive move. It represents the area where institutional orders were last placed. Price will return to this area to activate remaining orders before continuing in the original direction.

Identifying a Valid Order Block

1. Find a strong, impulsive move (at least 3:1 body-to-wick ratio on multiple consecutive candles).
2. Look back to the LAST candle before the impulse that is OPPOSITE in direction.
3. That candle is your OB. For a bullish OB (before a bull impulse): it's the last bearish candle.
4. For a bearish OB (before a bear impulse): it's the last bullish candle.
5. Mark the OB from its OPEN to its CLOSE (body only for precision).
6. Extend the OB zone forward in time — valid until price returns and reacts.

CHAPTER 13 — SESSION STRATEGY

Understanding Market Sessions for Gold

Gold operates 23 hours a day (Sunday 22:00 – Friday 21:00 GMT). But not all hours are equal. Knowing WHEN institutions are most active transforms your win rate.

Highest probability for trend continuation

ASIAN SESSION: 00:00 – 06:00 GMT | Consolidation / range

London Session Behavior

London opens with a fake-out move in 60–70% of sessions. The first 30 minutes typically move in the direction opposite to the true London direction. Mark the Asian session high and low BEFORE London open. The first body-close break of Asian range = manipulation. Wait for it, then trade the reversal.

New York Session Behavior

NY (13:00 GMT) either continues the London move OR reverses it at 13:00–13:30. The 13:00 candle is critical. If it creates a FVG in the direction of London trend = continuation. If it sweeps the London low/high = potential reversal setup. NY close (17:00 GMT) = end of institutional trading. DO NOT trade after 17:00 GMT.

[SESSION MAP — XAUUSD TYPICAL DAILY STRUCTURE]

□□

ASIAN: flat LONDON: fake $\uparrow$, real $\downarrow$ setup, then $\uparrow$ NY: cont.

- END CHART ■■■

CHAPTER 14 — RISK MANAGEMENT

Risk management is the only controllable variable in trading. You cannot control whether your trade wins. You CAN control how much you lose. This chapter gives Oscar the exact system to survive drawdowns and compound capital consistently.

The 1% Model

Risk exactly 1% of account balance per trade. This means 100 consecutive losses are required to lose your entire account — a statistical near-impossibility if your edge is real.



Example: \$5,000 account | 1% risk = \$50 | SL = 25 pips

Drawdown Handling Rules

1. 3 consecutive losses: Stop trading for the day. Review setups. Resume tomorrow.
2. 5% drawdown from peak: Cut position size to 0.5% per trade until recovered.
3. 10% drawdown from peak: Stop trading for 1 week. Full strategy review.
4. Never move SL further from entry to avoid a loss — this is the #1 account-killer.
5. Partial profits: Take 50% off at 1:1 R:R, move SL to BE. Let runners go.
6. Never risk more than 2% total across all open trades simultaneously.

The Compounding Reality

At 1% risk with a 1:3 average R:R and 45% win rate, a \$1,000 account becomes \$1,482 in 100 trades. At 2% risk with the same stats, it becomes \$2,192. The difference between 1% and 2% seems small — but at 10% risk the account is blown 60% of the time. Protect capital first.

CHAPTER 15 — TRADE EXECUTION SYSTEM

Pre-Trade Checklist

1. BIAS: What is D1 saying? Bull or Bear? Is 4H aligned?
2. ZONE: What is the highest-probability zone price is approaching?
3. LIQUIDITY: What liquidity pool sits above/below the zone?
4. ENTRY MODEL: Which of the 4 Sniper models applies here?
5. SWEEP: Has price taken liquidity? Has the sweep candle closed back inside?
6. STRUCTURE SHIFT: Is there a M15 CHoCH/BOS confirming direction?
7. ENTRY: FVG or OB identified for limit order placement?
8. SL: Placed BEHIND the liquidity sweep. Buffer = 3–5 pips.
9. TP: Minimum 1:3 R:R to first target. Partial planned.
10. SIZE: Position calculated using 1% rule. Confirmed before order placed.
11. SESSION: Am I in London or NY kill zone? If no — WAIT.
12. NEWS: Any high-impact news in the next 30 minutes? If yes — WAIT.

Entry Confirmation

Limit orders are preferred over market orders. Place your limit order AT the FVG midpoint or OB zone before price arrives. This avoids emotional decision-making at the moment of execution. If price reaches your zone but your M15 CHoCH has NOT formed — do NOT enter. If CHoCH forms but price gaps past your zone — skip the trade.

Exit Strategy

- **Partial Exit 1 (50% of position):** At 1:1 R:R — guaranteed profit, moves SL to breakeven.
- **Partial Exit 2 (25% of position):** At next liquidity pool / HTF structural target.
- **Final Exit (25% of position):** Trail SL behind internal structure swings.
- **Full Exit:** If price breaks structure against you on 1H — close remaining position.
- **DO NOT:** Move TP closer because you're scared. Trust the model.
- **DO NOT:** Add to losers. Ever.

CHART EXAMPLE

[CASE STUDY 2 — 4H BEARISH OB SHORT (4H → M15)]

D1 Bias: BEARISH – LH/LL forming, below D1 supply

4H OB: 2378-2382 (last bullish candle before 35-pip drop)

Price rallied into 0B over 2 days

[illegible]

1H: price approaches 4H OB. BSL above 2381.5 (equal highs EQH)

M15: 10:30 GMT – candle sweeps to 2382.3, closes back at 2380.2

M15 CHOCH bearish: 11:00 GMT, close below 2379.5

M15 FVG: 2380.1 – 2380.8 (sell zone)

[illegible]

TRADE DETAILS:

Entry: SELL LIMIT @ 2380.4

SL: 2383.2 (above EQH sweep + 1-pip buffer)

Risk: 2.8 pips $\rightarrow$ \$5,000 acct, 1% = \$50 $\rightarrow$ 0.18 lots

TP1: 2372.0 (+8.4 pips) – 1H SSL

TP2: 2360.0 (+20.4 pips) – 4H SSL

TP3: 2345.0 (+35.4 pips) – D1 SSL

Final R:R = 1:12.6 (TP3) | TP1 R:R = 1:3.0

Profit at TP2: $\$50 \times 7.3 = \365

■ D1 bearish + 4H OB + BSL sweep = PERFECT institutional setup.

■ The 2.8-pip SL is elite-level precision — only possible via FVG refinement.

■ This is the type of trade that defines professional vs retail.

END CHART

CASE STUDY 3: Equal Highs Stop Hunt Reversal

CHART EXAMPLE

[CASE STUDY 3 — EQH STOP HUNT → SHORT (M15)]

4H: Bearish. 1H: LH/LL. Price formed THREE equal highs at 2395

Massive BSL sitting above 2395 – retail placed shorts here 3x

[illegible]

NY session 13:15 GMT:

2397 | * SWEEP – candle wicks to 2397.8 (BSL grabbed)

2395 | ■■ EQH ■■ EQH ■■ EQH ■■ (all at same price)

2393 | |

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2391 | | ← price dumps immediately after sweep
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2388 | \ ← M15 close below 2391 = CHoCH bearish

2385 | ____ FVG: 2392.5-2393.2 ← retest entry

2382 | _____→ target zone: 2370

[illegible]

TRADE DETAILS:

Entry: SELL @ 2392.8 (FVG retest after CHoCH)

SL: 2398.3 (above sweep high + buffer)

TP1: 2381 | TP2: 2370 | TP3: 2355

R:R to TP2 = 1:4.1

- THREE equal highs = institutional target. Never fade this setup.
- The sweep is aggressive — 2.8 pips above EQH — classic institutional grab.
- FVG after CHoCH = second-chance entry. Often better than catching the initial reversal.

■■■ END CHART ■■■

CASE STUDY 4: NY Continuation + HTF Confluence

[CASE STUDY 4 — NY CONTINUATION SELL (M15 + 4H CONFLUENCE)]

London FVG: 2354-2358. NY pullback into this FVG expected.

2332 | _____→ TP zone

R:R to TP1 = 1:4.1 | to TP2 = 1:7.6

- Pre-set limit order in FVG = no emotional execution needed.
- London FVG + NY timing confluence = textbook institutional continuation.
- Model 3 (NY Continuation) executed perfectly here.

CASE STUDY 5: Inducement Trap into Demand Zone

[CASE STUDY 5 — IDM TRAP + STRONG DEMAND ZONE BUY (1H → M15)]

[illegible][illegible]

■ This is why you WAIT for SSH demand confluence before buying anything.

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CHAPTER 17 — PSYCHOLOGY

The market does not beat traders. Traders beat themselves. The technical setup is only half the battle — your internal state determines whether you can execute the setup without interference.

Discipline

Discipline is NOT about being emotionless. It is about having a process so clear that there is nothing to decide in the moment. Every 'should I take this trade?' question is answered by your checklist — not by your gut. Build systems, not willpower.

Patience

The best trades set up 1–3 times per week. Not every day. Not multiple times per session. If you are trading 10+ times a week on XAUUSD, you are gambling, not trading. Elite traders sit on their hands for 80% of the week and strike with maximum precision on the remaining 20%.

The 5 Enemies

1. **Revenge Trading:** Taking trades to recover a loss. Solution: mandatory 2-hour break after any loss.
2. **FOMO (Fear of Missing Out):** Chasing price after a move. Solution: if you missed it, mark the next zone and wait.
3. **Overtrading:** Trading to feel 'busy'. Solution: hard limit of 2 trades per day. Stop after 2.
4. **Moving SL:** Giving losers room they don't deserve. Solution: SL is LOCKED after entry. Period.
5. **Early Exit:** Closing winning trades before TP. Solution: once SL is at BE, let the trade run. Do not look.

Mindset Reframe

You are not trying to make money on this trade. You are trying to execute the model correctly. If you execute the model correctly 100 times, the money takes care of itself. Judge yourself on process quality, not on outcome. A perfectly executed trade that loses is a SUCCESS. A poorly executed trade that wins is a WARNING.

CHAPTER 18 — OSCAR'S DAILY ROUTINE

Structure creates consistency. This routine is designed around Oscar's trading framework and session windows. Adapt timings as needed for your timezone.

PRE-MARKET (Before 06:30 GMT)

1. Review D1 chart: What did price do yesterday? Any new structure breaks?
2. Mark D1 and 4H key levels: supply/demand zones, OBs, FVGs.
3. Mark Previous Day High (PDH) and Previous Day Low (PDL).
4. Mark Asian session high/low (forms by ~06:00 GMT).
5. Write your bias in your journal: 'D1 is ___. 4H is ___. I am looking to ___ today.'
6. Identify ONE primary trade setup. What zone is price approaching?
7. Set limit orders if zone is clear and pre-defined.

LONDON KILL ZONE (07:00–09:30 GMT)

1. Watch the first 30 minutes — DO NOT trade the first 10 minutes.
2. Is price sweeping ASH or ASL? Note the sweep direction.
3. Wait for M15 CHoCH after sweep. Place entry at FVG/OB.
4. If no clear setup by 09:30 — CLOSE the charts. Do NOT force.

MID-SESSION REVIEW (10:30–12:30 GMT)

1. Review open trades. Are they progressing? Any structure breaks?
2. Do NOT enter new trades unless a perfect Model 4 pullback presents.
3. Journal any observations about price behaviour.

NY KILL ZONE (12:30–14:00 GMT)

1. 13:00 GMT candle is critical — watch structure.
2. Is NY continuing London? Look for Model 3 FVG entry.
3. Is NY reversing London? Look for Model 1 sweep at London high/low.
4. Maximum 1 additional trade in NY after London trade.

POST-SESSION (17:00–18:00 GMT)

1. Close all intraday trades. Do not hold low-conviction positions overnight.
2. Journal: What setups appeared? Did you follow the checklist? Why or why not?
3. Screenshot your charts — wins AND losses.
4. Review the day's trades. What would you do differently?
5. Rate your discipline 1-10. Aim for 8+ regardless of P&L.;

WEEKLY REVIEW (Sunday, before markets open)

1. Review ALL trades from the week — full chart review.
2. Calculate win rate, average R:R, total R gained/lost.
3. Identify recurring mistakes. Add to a 'mistake list'.
4. Read the mistake list before Monday's session.
5. Set weekly objectives: not P&L; targets, but process targets.

CHAPTER 19 — MASTER PRE-TRADE CHECKLIST

Print this page. Keep it next to your screen. Complete EVERY item before clicking 'Buy' or 'Sell'.

BIAS CONFIRMATION

- D1 bias confirmed: Bullish / Bearish / Neutral
- 4H structure aligned with D1 bias
- 1H internal structure agreeing with 4H

ZONE QUALIFICATION

- Zone is FRESH (untested)
- Zone created by impulsive departure
- Zone caused a BOS on departure
- Zone is in Premium (supply) or Discount (demand)
- OB or FVG confluence inside the zone

LIQUIDITY CHECK

- Liquidity pool identified above/below zone
- Liquidity sweep HAS occurred (not pending)
- Sweep candle closed BACK inside the zone/level

EXECUTION TRIGGER

- M15 CHoCH has formed in trade direction
- FVG or OB identified for limit entry
- Entry price set at FVG midpoint or OB body

RISK PARAMETERS

- SL placed behind liquidity sweep (3-5 pip buffer)
- TP minimum 1:3 R:R (TP1)
- Position size calculated: ____ lots
- Risk in \$ confirmed: $\leq 1\%$ of account = \$____

SESSION & NEWS

- In London or NY kill zone
- No high-impact news within 30 minutes
- Not trading after 17:00 GMT

PSYCHOLOGY CHECK

- I have NOT traded today yet / max 2 trades reached: STOP
- I am NOT in revenge mode from an earlier loss
- I am NOT chasing – this setup was pre-planned
- I accept that this trade may lose – and that is fine

here is NO trade.

Incomplete checklist = skip the setup. The next one will come

CHAPTER 20 — CONCLUSION

Oscar, you now hold a complete institutional-grade framework for trading XAUUSD. Not a collection of indicators. Not a system based on hope. A systematic, repeatable, logic-based approach built on the same principles that professional traders use every day.

The market will test you. There will be weeks where nothing sets up perfectly. There will be trades that follow the checklist exactly and still lose. That is the nature of a probabilistic game. What separates the top 5% from the rest is not who has the best setup — it is who stays consistent through the noise.

The Path Forward

1. DEMO FIRST: Trade the Sniper Strategy on demo for 30 days minimum. Track every trade.
2. JOURNAL: Every trade documented. Screenshot, notes, grade.
3. LIVE (SMALL): Start live with a small account. Treat it like a business. Protect capital.
4. SCALE: Only when you have 3 consecutive months of positive results, scale up.
5. REVIEW: Weekly analysis. Monthly strategy review. Quarterly framework refinement.
6. COMMUNITY: Find other disciplined traders. Share ideas, not tips.
7. PATIENCE: This framework compounds. Give it time. The market rewards consistency.

"The sniper does not fire at every target. He waits for the perfect shot. In trading, patience is not a passive quality — it is your most powerful weapon."

— Oscar, XAUUSD Domination

XAUUSD DOMINATION — Institutional Sniper Strategy Blueprint

Author: Oscar | Smart Money Concepts Framework | CONFIDENTIAL

This document is for educational purposes only and does not constitute financial advice. All trading involves risk. Never trade with money you cannot afford to lose.